

DISPOSABLE — Big Fish datasets assessment (2026-09-03)

Purpose: COMPASS read on Alex’s Sep 2–3 “Big Fish” panels — fit for HERO / peer-context / cross-domain work.

Source: Alex Gates emails in each `datasets/*/Re_ New dataset for Big Fish.eml`.

Active focus (Charles): Legends (LoL) — see `legends_sandbox/_DISPOSABLE_legends_hero_thread.md`.

Say `anchor` in chat to paste the priority table below.

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PD30 (Sep 4): Big Fish = **backup portfolio / back burner** — not primary time sink. **Primary = paper flipbook + story outline.** Army · MBB · Tenure stay main line. See `transcripts/PD30_notes.md`.

Priority	Dataset	Path	PD30 verdict	Next action
—	Paper talk	<code>3-Master_Plan/re_entry/</code>	P0 primary	Flipbook: question → figure → claim
B1	Football	<code>datasets/football/</code>	Composite porch fail ; usage LOO interesting	Usage congestion slide for story; no deep composite chase
B2	Legends (LoL)	<code>datasets/legends/</code>	One metric weak; no reigning HERO	Background poke only
B3	NELS88	<code>datasets/nels88/</code>	Not shown	Education porch when background time
B4	HSB80	<code>datasets/hsb80/</code>	Not shown	Same
B5	Apache	<code>datasets/Apache/</code>	Not shown	Same

Alex one-liner (PD30): “Backup on our backup plan” — perf metric storyboard validates **screen fast, don’t sink weeks**; hit rate says congestion can work again, but **MBB/tenure/army** are still the bet.

Naming map (Charles shorthand → repo)

Charles said	Actual folder	Domain
league	<code>datasets/legends/</code>	League of Legends esports
nlb88	<code>datasets/nels88/</code>	NELS:88 education
football	<code>datasets/football/</code>	FBS → NFL draft
hsb80	<code>datasets/hsb80/</code>	HS&B:80 education
apache	<code>datasets/Apache/</code>	Apache OSS → PMC

Overall verdict

All five could be useful, but for different jobs:

Dataset	Best role in dissertation
Legends	Fourth empirical domain with a real advancement gate (dev → top tier)
Football	Second sports/draft replication of MBB
Apache	Open-source governance domain — promotion to PMC as Y
NELS88	Education “small pond” complement to tenure
HSB80	Larger education robustness check (cohort-split)

None replace MBB or **tenure** as anchors. They extend cross-domain coverage and give Alex’s Big Fish framework more places to land.

Binding frame (environment ≠ advancement)

Domain	Environment (pond LOO)	Advancement Y	Selection clarity
MBB (anchor)	team LOO	draft	Strong
Tenure (anchor)	dept LOO	tenure	Strong
Legends	dev-team LOO	top-tier promotion	Strong
Football	team LOO	NFL draft	Strong
Apache	project-year candidate pool LOO	PMC promotion	Strong (with roster censor caveat)
NELS / HSB	school LOO	degree attainment	Weaker (attainment ≠ top-K select)

1. Legends (LoL) — highest priority

Path: datasets/legends/lol_big_fish_player_split_panel.csv
Docs: datasets/legends/README.md

Stat	Value
Rows	66,752 player×team×league×split×position stints
Columns	84
Years	2015–2026
Unique players	~10,664

HERO slot	Column	Fill / note
Unit	player_period_id	100%
Pond	teamid / dev league split	Explicit league_tier
Â	own_performance_index	79.6%
Peer LOO	teammate_mean_performance_excl_self	91.7% — primary LOO
Same-role LOO	same_role_mean_performance_excl_self	26.6% — sparse
Y	top_tier_debut_within_1y / _2y	3,052 / 4,456 True
Censor	full_1y_followup , full_2y_followup	Required before treating False as failure
Cohort filter	eligible_developmental_cohort	~15,983 dev rows

Why useful: Alex built this for the project. Dev-league → top-tier promotion is a clean advancement gate. Tier labels (developmental / top / other) support environment vs advancement separation. N is healthy for porch + elite-pond probes.

Caveats: Higher roster churn than MBB; esports may need one framing sentence for general readers; same_role LOO too sparse for primary spec.

COMPASS read: Start here. Full legends_sandbox/ mirroring tenure/MBB BDP → HERO porch on dev cohort.

2. Football — strong MBB parallel

Path: datasets/football/football_big_fish_player_season_panel/football_big_fish_player_season_panel.csv

Stat	Value
Rows	168,165 player-seasons
Eligible cohort	70,633 (eligible_analysis_cohort == 1)
Seasons	2014–2024
Unique players	~65,030

HERO slot	Column	Note
Â	own_performance_index	100% in eligible cohort; ~42% overall
Peer LOO	teammate_mean_performance_excl_self	99.9%
Same-group LOO	same_group_mean_performance_excl_self	72.2%
Y	drafted_next_draft	~2.7% in eligible (~1,900 picks)

Why useful: Draft-as-advancement, team-as-pond — structurally closest to MBB after LoL. Large eligible N; recruiting ranks as priors.

Caveats: Very sparse Y; OL / low-snap roles missing performance; only ~11 seasons; public data limits on opportunity for many positions.

COMPASS read: Worth football_sandbox/ after legends — analyze by position_group (QB/WR/DB vs OL).

3. Apache — OSS governance, real promotion gate

Path: datasets/Apache/apache_big_fish_panel.csv
Alex blurb: 10,537 contributors · 8 major projects · 2015–2024 · Git commits + activity → PMC promotion.

Stat	Value
Rows	14,217 contributor×project×year
Unique persons	~10,537
Projects	8 (airflow, beam, kafka, arrow, superset, nifi, cassandra, lucene)
Y (next year)	174 promotions (~1.2% raw)
Y (2y)	302 promotions
Activity screen (meets_activity_screen_3plus)	4,518 rows → 155 next-y promos (~3.4%)

HERO slot	Column	Note
Pond	<code>project</code> × <code>performance_year</code>	~260 median <code>team_active_candidates</code> per project-year
Â (own)	<code>commits</code> (+ <code>within_team_percentile</code> , <code>own_top_decile</code>)	Annual commit volume
Peer LOO	<code>peer_mean_commits_loo</code>	100% — LOO over active promotion candidates
Relative	<code>relative_to_peer_mean</code> , <code>peers_above</code>	Pre-built
Congestion proxy	<code>peer_top_decile_count_loo</code>	Count of top-decile peers in pond
Y	<code>promoted_to_pmc_next_year</code> / <code>promoted_to_pmc_within_2y</code>	Use <code>outcome_*_complete</code> flags
Screen	<code>meets_activity_screen_3plus</code>	Restrict to serious candidates (Alex intent)

Why useful:

- **Novel domain** — neither sports nor academia; “advancement” = PMC seat (governance, not draft/tenure).
- **Pre-built Big Fish LOO** on the *promotion candidate pool* within project-year — closer to “who gets the scarce slot” than education panels.
- **Cross-domain talking point:** peer congestion among active contributors predicts who reaches the management committee.
- Eight projects give a small **multi-pond** structure (project fixed effects or pooled porch).

Caveats (Alex flagged):

- Apache publishes **current** rosters, not full historical PMC/committer lists → **some past promotions unobserved** (right-censor / misclassification risk on Y).
- Sparse Y even after activity screen (~155 events in 4.5K screened rows).
- **Â = raw commits** is volume-heavy; no Alex composite index like LoL/football — may need commit-rate or tenure-adjusted ability.
- Identity resolution noisy (`identity_match_method` : mostly email-only).
- Not “selection from a ranked score” in the NFL sense — PMC promotion is partly social/political; score≠select story needs careful wording.

COMPASS read: Med–high — worth a lightweight porch on activity-screened rows **after** legends + football. Best as a **fifth panel** or appendix “open source governance” vignette, not a chapter anchor. Flag roster censor limitation in any figure caption.

4. NELS88 — education small pond

Path: `datasets/nels88/nels88_big_fish_panel.csv`

Stat	Value
Rows	10,545 students
Pond	10th-grade high school (<code>F1SCH_ID</code>)
Analytic (min 10 peers)	~7,238
Y	<code>bachelors_or_higher_by_2000</code> ~36% (min-10)

HERO slot	Column
Â	<code>own_performance_z</code> (baseline test)
Peer LOO	<code>peer_mean_loo</code> , <code>peer_mean_z_loo</code> (~97%)
Weights	<code>followup_weight_2000</code>

Why useful: Education complement to tenure; fast school LOO porch; connects to classic small-pond literature.

Caveats: Sampled students ≠ full school cohort; attainment not competitive selection; single peer snapshot → long lag to Y.

COMPASS read: Supporting evidence, not headline domain.

5. HSB80 — larger education N, cohort split

Path: `datasets/hsb80/hsb80_big_fish_panel.csv`

Stat	Value
Rows	22,889 (Sophomore 12,630 · Senior 10,259)
Analytic min-5	~22,058
Y	<code>bachelors_or_higher_by_1986</code> ~11% (min-5; cohort still young)

Why useful: ~2× NELS N; rich covariates (SES, GPA, school type).

Caveats: **Analyze Sophomore and Senior separately** (Alex); 1980s follow-up; same attainment-not-selection issue as NELS.

COMPASS read: Pair with NELS as mini **education bundle** for robustness.

Suggested sequencing (bandwidth) — PD30: back burner only

- 1. **Paper flipbook** — P0 (not a dataset; overrides list below)
- 2. **Football** — usage congestion slide wired; no composite chase
- 3. **Legends** — background poke if train/night energy
- 4. **Education bundle (NELS + HSB)** — when story needs a third domain
- 5. **Apache** — lowest urgency

Thread log

Date	Entry
2026-09-03	Initial COMPASS assessment of football, legends, nels88, hsb80, apache; legends selected as active focus.
2026-09-04	PD30: Big Fish demoted to backup; football usage LOO = story nugget; primary = paper outline.